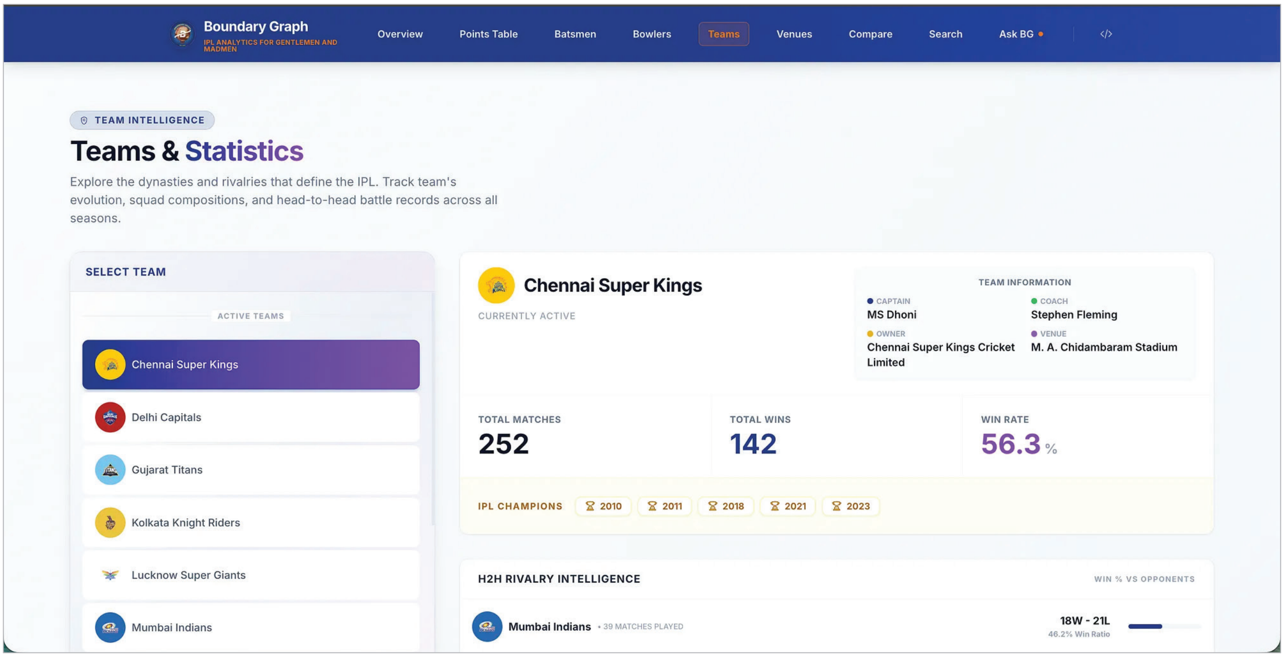

Figure 2: Teams and statistics

This shifts venue analysis from anecdotal commentary to structural evidence rooted in historical interaction patterns.

From scorecards to structures

Viewing the IPL through a graph lens reframes analysis from scorecards to structures. It enables reasoning that mirrors how the game unfolds as a network of evolving relationships shaped by context, continuity, and interaction. With hundreds of thousands of nodes and over a million relationships, the system is designed not just for historical analysis but for continuous evolution. The graph is updated as soon as a match concludes, allowing new performances, outcomes, and contextual shifts to be reflected immediately in the data model.

This foundation also enables more intuitive ways of interacting with the graph. An upcoming feature, 'Ask BG', introduces a natural language interface on top of the graph, allowing users to ask relationship-driven questions directly without writing queries. By combining real-time data updates with conversational access to the underlying graph, the platform moves closer to treating IPL analysis as a living system rather than a static archive, unlocking insights that traditional approaches struggle to surface.

Explore the boundary graph

The complete graph model and interactive exploration experience are available through the Boundary Graph application at *https://boundary-graph.netlify.app/*. The app allows readers to navigate players, teams, venues, and seasons through relationship-driven queries and visualisations, offering a deeper and more intuitive understanding of the IPL beyond tables and aggregates.

Beyond the boundary rope

Although the IPL provides a familiar and engaging dataset, the modelling principles demonstrated here extend far beyond sports analytics. Any domain where outcomes depend on interactions rather than isolated attributes benefits from graph-first thinking.

Common examples include:

- Recommendation engines built on user item interaction paths
- Fraud detection systems analysing transactional networks
- Knowledge graphs capturing evolving semantic relationships

The IPL serves as a compelling illustration of how graph models scale from theory to production.

Note: If you need more details and are unaware about the IPL cricket tournament, do visit the official website at *https://www.iplt20.com/*.

END

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